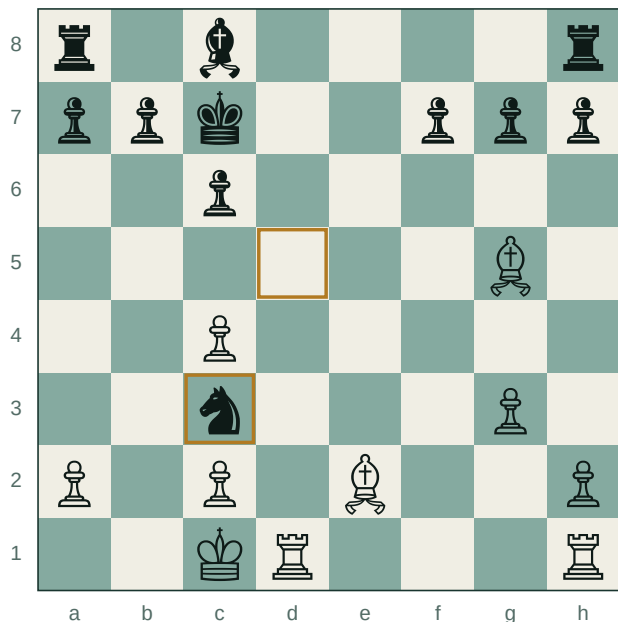


# Attraction tactics: White, move 17

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 16...Nc3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**17. Bf4+ Kb6 18. c5+ Kxc5 19. Be3+**

**17.Bf4+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **17...Kb6**.

**18.c5+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **18...Kxc5**.

**19.Be3+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -1 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on c7. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.